



Warm up

Circle the odd one out.



Although it is a tradition to exchange gifts on Christmas, Mrs March had told her daughters that there will be no Christmas gifts for them as there was a shortage of money due to the ongoing war. However, she promised that they would each find a book under their pillows. At first, the girls thought that Christmas would not be Christmas without presents, and decided to buy themselves a gift each with their pocket money. Then, they changed their minds and each of them decided to buy a gift for their mother (Marmee). Let's read more about Christmas morning at the March home.



Jo was the first to wake up in the grey dawn of Christmas morning. She remembered her mother's promise and, slipping her hand under her pillow, drew out a little crimson-covered book. She woke Meg with a 'Merry Christmas,' and told her to see what was under her pillow. There was a green book, with the same picture inside, and a few words written by their mother, which made their one present very precious in their eyes. Presently, Beth and Amy also woke up and found their little books, one dove-coloured, the other blue, and all sat looking at and talking about them, while the east grew rosy with the coming day.

Where were the girls? What time of the day was it?

"Where is Mother?" asked Meg, as she and Jo ran down to the kitchen to thank their mother for their gifts, half an hour later.

crimson-covered: with a crimson (deep red) coloured cover

“Some poor person came asking for help,” said Hannah, “and your ma went straight off to see what was needed.”

Hannah, their housekeeper, had lived with them since Meg was born and was now part of their family.

“She will be back soon, I think, so fry your cakes, and have everything ready,” said Meg, looking over the presents which were collected in a basket and kept under the sofa, ready to be presented to their mother at the proper time.

Jo was dancing about the room to take the first **stiffness** off the new slippers that she had got for their mother. Beth had marked a handkerchief for her and picked her a beautiful rose from the garden, and Amy had bought her a little bottle of **cologne**.

“There’s Mother! Hide the basket, quick!” cried Jo, as a door **slammed**, followed by footsteps in the hall. They quickly hid the basket under the sofa.

Why was the basket hidden under the sofa?

“Merry Christmas, Marmee! Thank you for our books. We read a few pages and mean to every day,” they all said in chorus.

“Merry Christmas, little daughters! I’m glad you began reading at once, and hope you will keep on reading. But, I want to say one word before we sit down. Not far from here lives a poor woman, Mrs Hummel, with a little newborn baby. Six children are **huddled** into one bed to keep from freezing, for they have no fire. There is nothing to eat over there, and the oldest boy came to tell me they were hungry and cold. My girls, will you give them your breakfast as a Christmas present?”

Which words mean ‘spoke all together’?

They were all unusually hungry, having waited nearly an hour, and for a minute no one spoke, only a minute, and then, Jo exclaimed, “I’m so glad you came before we began! Let’s take our breakfast there.”

“May I go and help carry the things to the poor little children?” asked Beth eagerly.

“I shall take the muffins,” added Amy, heroically giving up the article she most liked. Meg was already covering the **buckwheats**, and piling the bread into one big plate.

“I thought you’d do it,” said Mrs March, smiling. “You shall all go and help me, and when we come back, we will have bread and milk for breakfast. We’ll have a nice dinner to make up for giving up our breakfast.”

stiffness: state of being difficult to bend or move **cologne**: a type of perfume **slammed**: shut with a lot of force, making a loud noise
huddled: gathered closely together due to cold **buckwheats**: a dish made with flour from the buckwheat plant



They were soon ready, and the **procession** set out. Walking through narrow streets, they reached the bare room in which the Hummel family lived. It had broken windows, no fire, **ragged** bedclothes, a sick mother, a **wailing** baby, and a group of pale, hungry children cuddled under one old **quilt**, trying to keep warm.

“Oh! It is good angels come to us!” said the poor woman, crying for joy.

“Funny angels in hoods and **mittens**,” said Jo, and they all laughed together. In a few minutes, the room began to look happy and cheerful. Hannah, who had carried wood, made a fire, and **stopped up** the

Why did Mrs Hummel call the girls ‘good angels’?

Why did Jo say that they were ‘funny angels’?

Who all were part of the ‘procession’?

broken panes with old newspaper. Mrs March gave the mother tea and **gruel**, and comforted her with promises of help. In the meantime, the girls spread the table, set the children round the fire, and fed them like so many hungry birds.

“This is good!” said the children as they ate and warmed their hands in front of the fire.

That was a very happy breakfast for the March sisters, though they didn’t get any of it.

“That’s loving our neighbour better than ourselves, and I like it,” said Meg, as they set out their presents while their mother was upstairs collecting clothes for the poor Hummels.

“She’s coming! **Strike up** the **march**, Beth! Open the door, Amy! Three cheers for Marmee!” cried Jo, dancing about while Meg went to **conduct** Mother to the seat of honour.

In your own words, explain what Meg means by saying, “That’s loving our neighbour better than ourselves.”

Beth played a march on the piano, Amy threw open the door, and Meg gave Mrs March a grand **escort** to her seat. Mrs March was both surprised and touched, and smiled with her eyes full as she examined her presents and read the little notes which accompanied them. The slippers went on at once, a new handkerchief was

procession: a group of people moving forward in an orderly manner for some purpose
wailing: crying loudly **quilt**: a bed cover made of two layers of cloth with a soft filling
ragged: old and torn **mittens**: gloves that cover the four fingers together and the thumb separately **stopped up**: covered **gruel**: a dish made by boiling any kind of grain in milk or water
strike up: start **march**: a piece of music written for marching to **conduct**: lead
escort: the act of accompanying someone to their destination in a grand manner



slipped into her pocket, well-scented with Amy's cologne, a rose was **fastened** in her hat, and a nice pair of gloves fitted perfectly.

There was a good deal of laughing and talking, in the simple way which makes these family festivals so pleasant, so sweet to remember long afterward.

Adapted from *Little Women*

Louisa May Alcott (1832–1888) was an American novelist and poet. *Little Women* is set in her own hometown and is based on her experience of growing up with three sisters. Many small events that take place in the book are also taken from things that actually happened in her family.



In this section, we will:

- remember details about the story.
- infer and interpret the main ideas of the story. (C-2.1, C-2.2, C-3.3)

Make connections

Map the story

Write down the list of things given in the prompts below.

the **5** gifts Mrs March received.

the names of the **4** sisters.

the **3** items from the Christmas breakfast that the girls took to the Hummel home.

the **2** words used in the story to describe how Mrs March felt when she received her gifts.

1 word that describes how the March family felt after giving away their Christmas breakfast

fastened: fixed something in a particular position

Deep dive

Answer the following questions with reference to context.

1. *They were all unusually hungry, having waited nearly an hour, and for a minute no one spoke, only a minute, and then, Jo exclaimed, "I'm so glad you came before we began! Let's take our breakfast there."*

RECALL

- a. Who was Jo speaking to and where did 'they' intend to take their breakfast?

INFER

- b. Why had 'they' waited nearly for an hour to begin their breakfast?

ANALYSE

- c. What do these lines tell us about the March sisters?

2. *That was a very happy breakfast for the March sisters, though they didn't get any of it. "That's loving our neighbour better than ourselves, and I like it," said Meg ...*

RECALL

- a. Who ate the breakfast?

INFER

- b. Why was the breakfast a happy one, even though the March sisters didn't eat anything?

ANALYSE

- c. What experience from your life does this incident remind you of?

Read, reflect and write

1. What kind of a person was Mrs March?
2. The main idea or message of a story is called its **moral**. What do you think is the moral of this story?
3. What are some ways in which you can celebrate a festival in a way that benefits others and makes you happy too?

Integrate

The March sisters took their Christmas breakfast to a family that needed food.

We all need nutritious food to be happy and healthy. Unfortunately, nearly one-third of the total food across the world goes to waste while on the other hand, millions of people go to bed hungry. Learn more about food wastage and work in groups to design a noticeboard to raise awareness about it at school. Remember to include informative pictures in your design.



Word wall



Musical instruments

Beth plays the piano. A person who plays the piano is called a **pianist**.

In each column, **circle** the correct name we use for a person who plays the given instrument.

flute	drum	bagpipes	saxophone	violin	trumpet
flautist	drummist	pipist	saxophonist	violinist	trumpetist
fluter	drummer	piper	saxophoner	violinier	trumpeter

Words from the story

Make sentences of your own with the following words.

huddled ragged fastened procession heroically

Interjection

Read the given sentence.

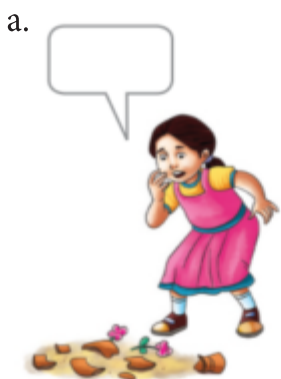
- “**Oh!** It is good angels come to us!”

In this sentence, *Oh!* is an **interjection**.

An **interjection** is a word that expresses a sudden feeling.

Look at the pictures and choose an interjection from the box for each of the speech bubbles given below. Then, use the interjections in sentences of your own.

Hmm ... Oops! Phew! Yay! Yuck! Ouch!



d.



e.



f.



Grammar time



Adverbs of place

Read the given sentences.

- Not far away from **here** lives a poor woman.
- Let's take our breakfast **there**.

The words highlighted in the examples above are **adverbs of place**. They answer the question—**WHERE?**

(**Where** does the poor woman live? She lives not far away from *here*.)

Where shall we take our breakfast? Let's take it *there*.)

In this section, we will:

- identify and use adverbs of place correctly.
- use the correct form of adverb based on the degrees of comparison. (C-3.4)

Adverbs are words that describe verbs, adjectives and other adverbs. They are used to express **manner**, **place**, **time** and **degree**.

Adverbs of place are words that tell us **where** something happens.

Use the adverbs of place given in the box to complete the sentences given below. One has been done for you.

upstairs

away

here

nearby

there

everywhere

1. Wait here. I will be back in a minute.
2. Go to the next building. You might find her _____.
3. The crow flew _____.
4. My room is _____. Please go to the second floor.
5. Where were you? We were looking for you _____!
6. Is there a post office _____?

It's interesting to see how some words work as both adverbs and prepositions.

Adverb of place

We sat **down**.

I looked **up**.

The children played **outside**.

Preposition

We ran **down** the hill.

I ran **up** the stairs.

There was a swing **outside** the house.

Prepositions are followed by nouns or pronouns.

Degrees of comparison

We can use different forms of the same adverb to show *change* or to make *comparisons*.

Read the given sentences.

- Beth and Amy woke up **early**.
- Meg woke up **earlier** than Beth and Amy.
- Jo woke the up **earliest** (of all).

Adverbs of place like 'here' and 'there' cannot be compared.

Read this table to learn how these degrees of comparison are formed.

Adverbs	Positive	Comparative	Superlative
short/one syllable adverbs	hard soon	harder sooner	hardest soonest
adverbs ending in -ly (<i>early</i> is an exception)	seriously carefully	more seriously more carefully	most seriously most carefully
some exceptions	well badly	better worse	best worst

Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the adverbs given in brackets.

- Many athletes run _____ but Usain Bolt runs the _____. (fast)
- The force of the wind carried the kite _____ and _____. (high)
- The city of Kathmandu was _____ damaged by the earthquake. (badly)
- One group of pilgrims walked _____ than the rest. (slowly)
- The audience cheered _____ for all the performers, but they cheered _____ for the drummer. (loudly)



Pronunciation



Words with the letters **ch**

1. Say these words aloud with your teacher. Listen carefully to the sound of the letters **ch** in each of them.

chores → (/ch/)

chef → (/sh/)

ache → (/k/)

2. Read the words given below. Sort the list of words according to the different sounds of the letters **ch**.

parachute

anchor

chilli

chocolate

chameleon

chips

chauffeur

chemical

charade

chores (/ch/)

chef (/sh/)

ache (/k/)

Write well

Descriptive writing: Using the five senses

When we describe a person, place, thing or event, we should choose words that evoke our senses. This helps the reader to use their imagination and picturize the thing we are describing.

1. Read the passage given below and use crayons to highlight the words connected to the five senses in the colour codes given below. One has been done for you.

Sight	Smell	Sound	Touch	Taste
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As I entered the fair, the vibrant colours of the paper lanterns greeted my eyes. The air was full of joyful laughter of children having the time of their lives. The Ferris wheel stood tall, its metallic frame glinting in the sunlight. Nearby, a merry-go-round spun with a melody of cheerful tunes. There were brightly decorated stalls lined up one after the other.

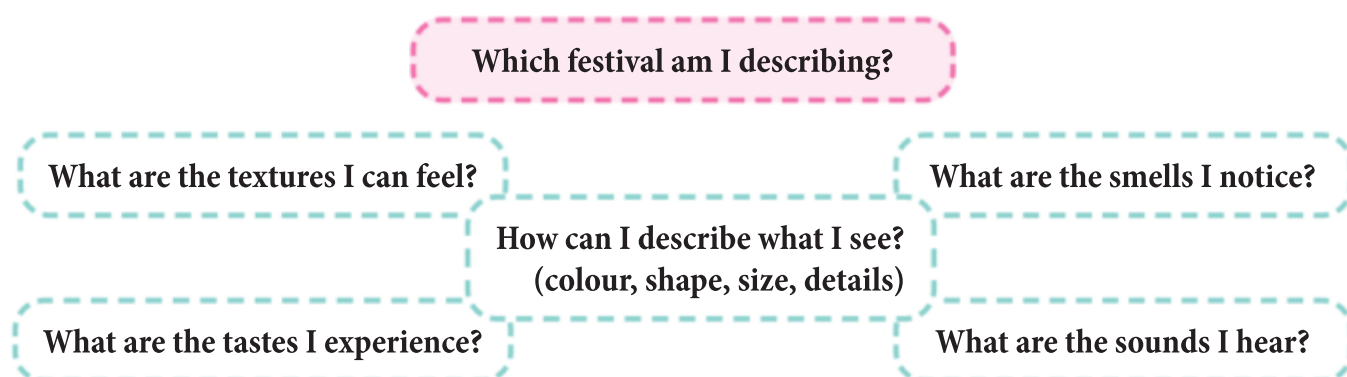
The gentle breeze ruffled my hair gently and the aroma of freshly made popcorn wafted through the air. The colourful banners of the ice golawalla's cart called out to me. His hands gently shaped the ice shavings into a ball on top of a stick. He poured a red-coloured syrup

over it and handed it to me in exchange for a few jingling coins. The sticky, sugary ice *gola* (snow cone) tasted heavenly. The hint of black salt in it tingled on my tongue.

I walked further and saw richly coloured fabrics fluttering in the stalls. The street hawkers' calls surrounded me completely, competing for attention.

As I reached a handicraft stall, I grazed my finger over the rough, handmade terracotta pots that had a pleasant earthy smell. The air was filled with the aroma of roasted peanuts and smoky grilled corn. As the sun began to set, casting a warm glow over the ground, I couldn't help but feel grateful for the moments of magic I had experienced.

2. Now, describe a festival you celebrate along with its accompanying traditions, using the five senses chart given below. Ensure that your description includes vivid images that appeals to sight, sound, taste, touch and smell, offering a rich sensory experience.



Listen and speak well



In Louisa Alcott's stories, there is no mention of things like televisions, computers or mobile phones because those things were not invented then. Inventions change our lives.

In this section, we will:

- listen to an audio and make inferences.
- participate in a debate and express our personal views regarding a topic. (C-1.1, C-1.3)

Listen to an account of what schools in 2050 might be like. Now, divide your class into two teams and take turns to speak. One team will take the stand that schooling today is better than what it will be in 2050. The other team will argue that schooling will be better in 2050. At the end of the debate, your teacher will tell you which team had stronger points and better arguments. Given below are some expressions you can use to share your point of view.

The way I see it ...

... on the other hand ...

That's not always true because ...

In my opinion ...

Could you specify what you mean by ...

Look at it this way ...